



GUIDELINE

Clinical Abbreviations

Scope (Staff):	All NMHS Mental Health (MH) Staff
Scope (Area):	All NMHS MH Areas

1. Aim

The aim of this guideline is to ensure all staff use consistent abbreviations and symbols in documentation, and to eliminate the use of ambiguous and error prone terminology to reduce the likelihood of misinterpretation and harm to patients.

2. Risk

A failure to use consistent abbreviations and symbols in documentation may lead to confusion and compromise patient care at all points of treatment, handover, and transfer of care. This has the potential to result in clinical incident.

3. Key Points

All staff are reminded that any abbreviation should be used with caution and, if there is possibility of confusion, the word or symbol should be written in full. This guideline outlines when abbreviations can and cannot be used in clinical documentation.

Any abbreviation outside of this guideline is not approved for use in clinical documentation at Mental Health unless it complies with the criteria outlined in the Use of Abbreviations below.

This guideline applies to all medical records whether hard copy, electronic, a hybrid of both or in other forms and replaces any local abbreviation lists held at discipline or department level.

This guideline applies to all staff within the NMHS Mental Health responsible for documenting in the patient medical record.

4. Use of Abbreviations

- Abbreviations are not to be used in inter-hospital transfer documents.
- Terms appearing in this document may only be abbreviated as defined or written in full.
- Use this approved abbreviation list and associated reference documents.
- The wording is to be written in full the first time it is used, followed with the abbreviation in brackets.
 - The abbreviation may be used thereafter in that episode or occasion of documentation.
 - Medical diagnosis must always be written in full.

- All staff are reminded that any abbreviation should be used with caution and, if there is possibility of confusion, the word or symbol should be written in full.
4. Local abbreviations must be endorsed by the Area Health Record Committee and be included in the standard list prior to use.

Prescribing of Medication

Refer to MHPHDS MH Medication Prescribing, Administration and Management For Inpatients

Hospital and Health Care Areas Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
AAU	ACUTE ASSESSMENT UNIT
ACU	ACUTE CARE UNIT
ACAT	AGED CARE ASSESSMENT TEAM
ATT	ASSESSMENT AND TREATMENT TEAMS
CSSD	CENTRAL STERILE SUPPLY DEPARTMENT
CASS	CLINICAL ACCOMMODATION SUPPORT SERVICE
CAMHS	CHILD AND ADOLESCENT MENTAL HEALTH SERVICE
CECAT	CREATIVE EXPRESSION CENTRE AND ART THERAPY
CLMIDRB	CRIMINAL LAW MENTALLY IMPAIRED DEFENDANTS' REVIEW BOARD
CMO	COMMUNITY MANAGED ORGANISATION
CCU	CORONARY CARE UNIT
CBT	COGNITIVE BEHAVIOURAL THERAPY
CCI	CENTRE FOR CLINICAL INTERVENTIONS
CTT	CLINICAL TREATMENT TEAM
CRC	CENTRE FOR CLINICAL RESEARCH
DBT	DIALECTICAL BEHAVIOURAL THERAPY
DCD	DEPARTMENT FOR COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT
DCPFS	DEPARTMENT FOR CHILD PROTECTION & FAMILY SUPPORT

DOH	DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH
DSS	DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL SERVICES
DTU	DAY THERAPY UNIT
DSC	DISABILITY SERVICES COMMISSION
ED	EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT
EMyU	EAST METROPOLITAN YOUTH UNIT
FH	FREMANTLE HOSPITAL
FSH	FIONA STANLEY HOSPITAL
FSHFHG	FIONA STANLEY FREMANTLE HOSPITALS GROUP
GH	GRAYLANDS HOSPITAL
HaDSCO	HEALTH AND DISABILITY SERVICE COMPLAINT OFFICE
HCC	HEALTH CONSUMERS' COUNCIL
HiTH	HOSPITAL IN THE HOME
HECS	HOSPITAL EXTENDED CARE SERVICE
ICOT	INTENSIVE CLINICAL OUTREACH TEAM
ICU	INTENSIVE CARE UNIT
ICLS	INDIVIDUALISED COMMUNITY LIVING STRATEGY
JCMH	JOONDALUP COMMUNITY MENTAL HEALTH
JHC	JOONDALUP HEALTH CAMPUS
KEMH	KING EDWARD MEMORIAL HOSPITAL FOR WOMEN
MBU	MOTHER and BABY UNIT
MHERL	MENTAL HEALTH EMERGENCY RESPONSE LINE
MHOA	MENTAL HEALTH OBSERVATION AREA
MCMH	MIRRABOOKA COMMUNITY MENTAL HEALTH CLINIC
MHC	MENTAL HEALTH COMMISSION
MHT	MENTAL HEALTH TRIBUNAL

MHU	MENTAL HEALTH UNIT
MiTH	MENTAL HEALTH HOSPITAL IN THE HOME (TOPAS/WEBPAS NAMING ONLY)
MRU	MERCY RESTORATIVE UNIT
MHAS	MENTAL HEALTH ADVOCACY SERVICE
NH	NURSING HOME
NSU	NEUROSCIENCES UNIT
NDIS	NATIONAL DISABILITY INSURANCE SCHEME
NMHS MHPHDS	NORTH METROPOLITAN HEALTH SERVICES MENTAL HEALTH, PUBLIC HEALTH, AND DENTAL SERVICES
NGO	NON-GOVERNMENT ORGANISATION
OAMHS	OLDER ADULT MENTAL HEALTH SERVICE
OCMH	OSBORNE COMMUNITY MENTAL HEALTH
OPH	OSBORNE PARK HOSPITAL
PARK	PEEL AND ROCKINGHAM KWINANA
PMA / PART	PREVENTION AND MANAGEMENT OF AGGRESSION
PECU	PSYCHIATRIC EXTENDED CARE UNIT
QEII	QUEEN ELIZABETH II MEDICAL CENTRE
RACF	RESIDENTIAL AGED CARE FACILITY
RFDS	ROYAL FLYING DOCTOR SERVICE
RPH	ROYAL PERTH HOSPITAL
RPBG	ROYAL PERTH BENTLEY GROUP
SARC	SEXUAL ASSAULT RESOURCE CENTRE
SAT	STATE ADMINISTRATIVE TRIBUNAL
SCGH	SIR CHARLES GAIRDNER HOSPITAL
SCGH MHU	SIR CHARLES GAIRDNER HOSPITAL MENTAL HEALTH UNIT
SCGH MHS	SIR CHARLES GAIRDNER HOSPITAL MENTAL HEALTH SERVICE

SCGHOPHG	SIR CHARLES GAIRDNER HOSPITAL OSBORNE PARK HEALTH CARE GROUP
SFMHS	STATE FORENSIC MENTAL HEALTH SERVICES
SJOG	ST JOHN OF GOD HOSPITAL (LOCATION: MIDLAND / MURDOCH / SUBIACO / BUNBURY)
UFU	URSULA FRAYNE UNIT
WAEDOCS	WESTERN AUSTRALIAN EATING DISORDERS AND OUTREACH CONSULTANCY SERVICE
YHiTH	YOUTH HOSPITAL IN THE HOME
YACADS	YOUTH AND ADULT COMPLEX ATTENTIONAL DISORDERS SERVICE

Designations of Clinical Staff Abbreviations

Designations	Meaning
MEDICAL	
CP	CONSULTANT PSYCHIATRIST
DMO	DUTY MEDICAL OFFICER
DCS	DIRECTOR CLINICAL SERVICES
FRANZCP	FELLOW OF ROYAL AUSTRALIAN NEW ZEALAND COLLEGE OF PSYCHIATRISTS
GP	GENERAL PRACTITIONER
HOS	HEAD OF SERVICE
HOCS	HEAD OF CLINICAL SERVICE
INT	INTERN
MO	MEDICAL OFFICER
REG	REGISTRAR
RMO	REGISTERED MEDICAL OFFICER
SMO	SUPERVISED MEDICAL OFFICER

SMP	SENIOR MEDICAL PRACTITIONER
NURSING	
AIN	ASSISTANT IN NURSING
ASEN	ADVANCED SKILL ENROLLED NURSE
AMHP	AUTHORISED MENTAL HEALTH PRACTITIONER
CMHN	COMMUNITY MENTAL HEALTH NURSE
CN	CLINICAL NURSE
CNM	CINICAL NURSE MANAGER
CNS	CLINICAL NURSE SPECIALIST
CON	COORDINATOR OF NURSING
CNS(COM)	CLINICAL NURSE SPECIALIST COMMUNITY
DON	DIRECTOR OF NURSING
EMHN	ENROLLED MENTAL HEALTH NURSE
MCN	MOTHERCRAFT NURSE
MHNC	MENTAL HEALTH NURSE CLINICIAN
MHP	MENTAL HEALTH PRACTITIONER
MHNM	MENTAL HEALTH NURSE MANAGER
NE-MH	NURSE EDUCATOR – MENTAL HEALTH
NM	NURSE MANAGER
NP	NURSE PRACTITIONER
NS	NURSING STUDENT
RMHN	REGISTERED MENTAL HEALTH NURSE
RN	REGISTERED NURSE
SRN	SENIOR REGISTERED NURSE
SDN	STAFF DEVELOPMENT NURSE
SDE	STAFF DEVELOPMENT EDUCATOR

OTHER CLINICAL POSITIONS	
DO	DUTY OFFICER
AMHP	AUTHORISED MENTAL HEALTH PRACTITIONER
AHP	ABORIGINAL HEALTH PRACTITIONER
APD	ACCREDITED PRACTISING DIETITIAN
SIW	SUICIDE INTERVENTION WORKER
SMHP	SENIOR MENTAL HEALTH PRACTITIONER
TO	TRIAGE OFFICER
OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY	
Occ Therapy	OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY
OTIC	OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST IN CHARGE
OT	OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST
OTA	OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY ASSISTANT
OT STUDENT	OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY STUDENT
SOT	SENIOR OCCUPATIONAL THERAPIST
PHYSIOTHERAPY	
PT	PHYSIOTHERAPIST
PTA	PHYSIOTHERAPY ASSISTANT
PT STUDENT	PHYSIOTHERAPY STUDENT
SPT	SENIOR PHYSIOTHERAPIST
PEER SUPPORT	
AMHLO	ABORIGINAL MENTAL HEALTH LIAISON OFFICER
PSW	PEER SUPPORT WORKER
PSC	PEER SUPPORT COORDINATOR
PSYCHOLOGY	
CCP	CONSULTANT CLINICAL PSYCHOLOGIST

CP	CLINICAL PSYCHOLOGIST
CPR	CLINICAL PSYCHOLOGIST REGISTRAR
SCP	SENIOR CLINICAL PSYCHOLOGIST
TCP	TRAINEE CLINICAL PSYCHOLOGIST
SOCIAL WELFARE	
WO	WELFARE OFFICER
WO Student	WELFARE OFFICER STUDENT
SOCIAL WORK	
SSW	SENIOR SOCIAL WORKER
SW	SOCIAL WORKER
SW Student	SOCIAL WORK STUDENT

Medical and Associated Abbreviations

A

Abbreviation	Meaning
A & E	ACCIDENT AND EMERGENCY
A/C	AFTERCARE
A/S	AFTERNOON SHIFT
ADDIT	ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTATION
ADL	ACTIVITIES OF DAILY LIVING
ADMIN	ADMINISTRATION
AH	ALLIED HEALTH
AIDS	ACQUIRED IMMUNE DEFICIENCY SYNDROME
a.m.	MORNING (NOT FOR MEDICATION CHARTS)
ALOS	AVERAGE LENGTH OF STAY
Amb	AMBULATE / WALK

Appt.	APPOINTMENT
ASAP	AS SOON AS POSSIBLE
ATP	ALLOWANCE TO PATIENTS
AUDIT	ALCOHOL USE DISORDERS IDENTIFICATION TEST
AWOL	ABSENT WITHOUT LEAVE
Ax	ASSESSMENT
ATOR	AT TIME OF REPORT
AMS	ALTERED MENTAL STATE
AHD	ADVANCED HEALTH DIRECTIVE
ABI	ACQUIRED BRAIN INJURY
A&O	ALERT AND ORIENTATED

B

Abbreviation	Meaning
B/F	BREAST FED
BCC	BASAL CELL CARCINOMA
BD	TWICE A DAY (BIS IN DIE)
Bed Mob	BED MOBILITY
BMI	BODY MASS INDEX
BNO	BOWELS NOT OPEN
BO	BOWELS OPEN
BP	BLOOD PRESSURE
BPAD	BIPOLAR AFFECTIVE DISORDER
BIBP	BROUGHT IN BY POLICE
BPRS	BRIEF PSYCHIATRIC RATING SCALE
BPSD	BEHAVIOURAL AND PSYCHOLOGICAL SYMPTOMS IN DEMENTIA

BRA	BRIEF RISK ASSESSMENT
BSL	BLOOD SUGAR LEVEL
BW	BIRTH WEIGHT
B/g	BACKGROUND
BPD	BORDERLINE PERSONALITY DISORDER
Bro	BROTHER

C

Abbreviation	Meaning
C 1-7 inc	CERVICAL SPINE VERTEBRAE
C.L.M.I.-. A A	CRIMINAL LAW MENTALLY IMPAIRED ACCUSED ACT
CTO	COMMUNITY TREATMENT ORDER
C/o	CARE OF; COMPLAINS OF
CA	CARCINOMA
CANSAS	CAMBERWELL ASSESSMENT OF NEED SHORT APPRAISAL SCHEDULE
CAP	CRISIS AWARENESS PLAN
CAT/CT	COMPUTERISED AXIAL TOMOGRAPHY
CCF	CARDIAC CONGESTIVE FAILURE
CECAT	CREATIVE EXPRESSION CENTRE AND ART THERAPY
CK	CREATININE KINASE
CMP	CLIENT MANAGEMENT PLAN
CP	CARE PLAN
COAD	CHRONIC OBSTRUCTIVE AIRWAYS DISEASE
Cont.	CONTINUED

CPR	CARDIOPULMONARY RESUSCITATION
CSA	CHILDHOOD SEXUAL ABUSE
CSF	CEREBROSPINAL FLUID
CST	COPING AND SAFETY TOOL
CSU	CATHETER SPECIMEN OF URINE
CTS	CARE TRANSFER SUMMARY
CVA	CEREBROVASCULAR ACCIDENT
Cx	CERVIX
CXR	CHEST X-RAY
CALD	CULTURALLY AND LINGUISTICALLY DIVERSE
COB	COUNTRY OF BIRTH
CHI	CLOSED HEAD INJURY

D

Abbreviation	Meaning
DAST-10	DRUG ABUSE SCREENING Test
D & C	DILATION AND CURETTAGE (OF UTERUS)
D & C (T)	TERMINATION OF PREGNANCY BY D & C
D/C	DISCHARGE
D/L	DAILY LEAVE
D/S	DAY SHIFT
D/W	DISCUSSED WITH
DAP	DIAGNOSIS, ASSESSMENT, PLAN (Nursing notes only)
DC	DIRECT CURRENT

DDx	DIFFERENTIAL DIAGNOSIS
DOB	DATE OF BIRTH
DPM	DIPLOMA OF PSYCHOLOGICAL MEDICINE
DSM-4	DIAGNOSTIC STATISTICAL MANUAL 4th EDITION
DSM-5	DIAGNOSTIC AND STATISTICAL MANUAL 5th EDITION
DSP	DISABILITY SERVICES PENSION
DTs	DELERIUM TREMENS
DVT	DEEP VEIN THROMBOSIS
Dx	DIAGNOSIS
DSH	DELIBERATE SELF HARM
DAMA	DISCHARGE AGAINST MEDICAL ADVICE
DNA	DID NOT ATTEND
DSP	DISABILITY SUPPORT PENSION

E

Abbreviation	Meaning
e.g.,	FOR EXAMPLE,
EBT	EVIDENCE BASED TOOLS
ECG	ELECTROCARDIOGRAM
ECT	ELECTROCONVULSIVE THERAPY
EDL	EXTENDED DAILY LEAVE
EEG	ELECTRO ENCEPHALOGRAM
Edn	EDUCATION
EIP	EARLY INTERVENTION PSYCHOSIS
EUPD	EMOTIONALLY UNSTABLE PERSONALITY DISORDER
EPA	ENDURING POWER OF ATTORNEY

EPG	ENDURING POWER OF GUARDIANSHIP
Ex	EXERCISE
EF	EXECUTIVE FUNCTIONING
EGA	ESCORTED GROUND ACCESS
ENT	EAR, NOSE AND THROAT
EPSE	EXTRAPYRAMIDAL SIDE EFFECTS
ESR	ERYTHROCYTE SEDIMENTATION RATE
ETA	ESTIMATED TIME OF ARRIVAL
ETR	ESTIMATED TIME OF RETURN
EWC	ELECTRIC WHEELCHAIR
EtOH	ALCOHOL

F

Abbreviation	Meaning
FEP	FIRST EPISODE PSYCHOSIS
FH _x	FAMILY HISTORY
F/Up	FOLLOW UP
FBC	FULL BLOOD COUNT
FBP	FULL BLOOD PICTURE
FSH	FOLLICLE STIMULATING HORMONE
FTD	FORMAL THOUGHT DISORDER
F/N	FORTNIGHT
Fa	FATHER
FH _x	FAMILY HISTORY
FTB	FAMILY TAX BENEFIT

FYI	FOR YOUR INFORMATION
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G

Abbreviation	Meaning
GF	GUTTER FRAME
GAF	GLOBAL ASSESSMENT FUNCTIONING
GI	GASTROINTESTINAL
GIT	GASTROINTESTINAL TRACT
GTT	GLUCOSE TOLERANCE TEST
GA	GROUND ACCESS/GENERAL ANAESTHETIC
G&A	GUARDIAN AND ADMINISTRATION

H

Abbreviation	Meaning
H ₂ O	WATER
Hb	HAEMOGLOBIN
HEP	HEPATITIS
HIV	HUMAN IMMUNODEFICIENCY VIRUS
HoNOS	HEALTH OF THE NATION OUTCOME SCALE
Hrs.	HOURS
Ht	HEIGHT
HV	HOME VISIT
Hx	HISTORY
HACC	HOME AND COMMUNITY CARE
H/H	HOME HELP
Hsb	HUSBAND

I - J

Abbreviation	Meaning
Ind.	INDEPENDENT
IC	INFECTION CONTROL
ICD10-AM	INTERNATIONAL CLASSIFICATION OF DISEASES (AUSTRALIAN MODIFICATION) 10 TH EDITION
ICP	INTERCRANIAL PRESSURE
IDC	INDWELLING CATHETER
IM	INTRAMUSCULAR
IMI/IMI	INTRAMUSCULAR INJECTION
INR	INTERNATIONAL NORMALISED RATIO
IQ	INTELLIGENCE QUOTIENT
IUCD	INTRA-UTERINE CONTRACEPTIVE DEVICE
IV	INTRAVENOUS
IVP	INTRAVENOUS PYLEOGRAM
Ix	INVESTIGATIONS
Inpt	INPATIENT
Info.	INFORMATION
ID	IDENTIFICATION
IDDM	INSULIN DEPENDANT DIABETES MELLITUS
JVP	JUGULAR VENOUS PRESSURE

L

Abbreviation	Meaning
L)	LEFT
L (1-5) Inc	LUMBAR VERTEBRAL DISCS
L/S	LATE SHIFT
LAI	LONG-ACTING INJECTION
LOS	LENGTH OF STAY/
LA	LOCAL ANAESTHETIC
LFT	LIVER FUNCTION TESTS
LNMP	LAST NORMAL MENSTRUAL PERIOD
LOC	LOSS OF CONSCIOUSNESS
LP	LUMBAR PUNCTURE
LTM	LONG TERM MEMORY
LTML	LONG TERM MEMORY LOSS

M

Abbreviation	Meaning
MANCAS	MANCHESTER ASSESSMENT OF NEED CARE ASSESSMENT SCHEDULE
mane	IN THE MORNING
Max Assist	MAXIMUM ASSIST
MC & S	MICROSCOPY CULTURE AND SENSITIVITY
MCOT	MOBILE COMMUNITY OUTREACH TEAM
MDT	MULTIDISCIPLINARY TEAM
MEAMS	MIDDLESEX ELDERLY ASSESSMENT OF MENTAL STATE
MED	MEDICAL

mg	MILLIGRAM
MHA14/MHA2014	MENTAL HEALTH ACT 2014
MI	MYOCARDIAL INFARCTION
microg	MICROGRAM
Min Assist	MINIMUM ASSIST
Mist/Mixt	MIXTURE
MMSE	MINI MENTAL STATE EXAMINATION
Mod Assist	MODERATE ASSIST
MP	MISSING PERSON
MRSA	METHICILLIN-RESISTANT STAPHYLOCOCCUS AUREUS
MS	MULTIPLE SCLEROSIS
MSE	MENTAL STATE Examination
MSU	MIDSTREAM SPECIMEN OF URINE
MVA	MOTOR VEHICLE ACCIDENT
Mx	MANAGEMENT
Max	MAXIMUM
Med Cert	MEDICAL CERTIFICATE
Mo	MOTHER
Mod	MODERATE
Mtg	MEETING

N

Abbreviation	Meaning
N/A	NOT APPLICABLE
N/S	NIGHT SHIFT
NAD	NO ABNORMALITY DETECTED
NAH	NOT AT HOME
NCP	NURSING CARE PLAN
NCMH	NURSE COORDINATOR MENTAL HEALTH
NFA	NO FIXED ADDRESS; NO FURTHER ACTION
NFO.	NO FURTHER ORDERS
NG	NASO-GASTRIC
NGT	NASO-GASTRIC TUBE
NIDDM	NON-INSULIN DEPENDANT DIABETES MELLITUS
NJ	NASOJEJUNAL
NJT	NASOJEJUNAL TUBE
Nocte	AT NIGHT
NOF	NECK OF FEMUR
NOK	NEXT OF KIN
Nsg	NURSING
N	NORMAL
NBM	NIL BY MOUTH
Neuro	NEUROLOGICAL
NSSI	NON-SUICIDAL SELF INJURY

O

Abbreviation	Meaning
O/A	ON ADMISSION
O/E	ON EXAMINATION
O/R	OUTRIGHT
O/N	OVERNIGHT
O ₂	OXYGEN
Obs	OBSERVATIONS
OBS	ORGANIC BRAIN SYNDROME
OD	OVERDOSE
ONL	OVERNIGHT LEAVE

P

Abbreviation	Meaning
PPHx	PAST PSYCHIATRIC HISTORY
P	PULSE
PC	PRESENTING COMPLAINT
P/C	PHONE CALL
PEG	PERCUTANEOUS ENDOSCOPIC GASTROSTOMY
PF	PULPIT FRAME
PD	PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT
PHx	PERSONAL HISTORY
PH	PAST HISTORY
PID	PELVIC INFLAMMATORY DISEASE
p.m.	AFTERNOON (NOT FOR MEDICATION CHARTS)
PMH _x .	PAST MEDICAL HISTORY

PMP	PRE-MORBID PERSONALITY
PND	POST NATAL DEPRESSION
PO	PER ORAL
PPHx	PAST PSYCHIATRIC HISTORY
PR	PER RECTUM
PRA	PROGRESSIVE RISK ASSESSMENT
PRN	AS REQUIRED (PRO RE NATA)
PSP	PERSONAL AND SOCIAL PERFORMANCE
PSOLIS	PSYCHIATRIC SERVICES ONLINE INFORMATION SYSTEM
Pt(s)	PATIENT(S)
PTSD	POST TRAUMATIC STRESS DISORDER
PUO	PYREXIA OF UNKNOWN ORIGIN
PV	PER VAGINA
PVD	PERIPHERAL VASCULAR DISEASE
PCT	PHONE CALL TO
PCF	PHONE CALL FROM
P/Care	PERSONAL CARE
Pov	POINT OF VIEW

Q

Abbreviation	Meaning
QID.	FOUR TIMES A DAY (QUARTER IN DIE)
QoL	QUALITY OF LIFE
Quad	QUADRIPLEGIA

R

Abbreviation	Meaning
R)	RIGHT
R	RESPIRATIONS
RAMP	RISK ASSESSMENT AND MANAGEMENT PLAN
R&G	REQUESTED AND GIVEN
RBC	RED BLOOD CELLS
Re	IN REFERENCE TO/REGARDING
Rh -	RHESUS FACTOR NEGATIVE
Rh +	RHESUS FACTOR POSITIVE
RIB	REST IN BED
RTW	RETURNED TO WARD
Rx	TREATMENT
Rv	REVIEW
Rehab	REHABILITATION
Rtn	RETURNED

S

Abbreviation	Meaning
S (1-5) Inc	SACRAL VERTEBRAE
S/B	SEEN BY
SB Assist	STAND BY ASSIST
SCC	SQUAMOUS CELL CARCINOMA
SCZ	SCHIZOPHRENIA
SCHAFECTIVE D/O-	SCHIZOAFFECTIVE DISORDER
SES	SERVICE ENGAGEMENT SCALE

SIDS	SUDDEN INFANT DEATH SYNDROME
SOB	SHORT OF BREATH
SI	SUICIDAL IDEATION
SOOB	SIT OUT OF BED
SOEOB	SIT OVER EDGE OF BED
SS	SUPPORT SERVICES
SSCD	STATEWIDE STANDARDISED CLINICAL DOCUMENTATION
Staph	STAPHYLOCOCCUS
Stat	AT ONCE (STATIM)
STI	SEXUALLY TRANSMITTED INFECTION
STS	SIT TO STAND
STM	SHORT TERM MEMORY
Strep	STREPTOCOCCUS
SC	SUBCUTANEOUS
Sx	SYMPTOMS

T

Abbreviation	Meaning
T	TEMPERATURE
T (1-12) Inc	THORACIC VERTEBRAE
TC	THOUGHT CONTENT
TF	THOUGHT FORM
TB	TUBERCULOSIS
TD	TARDIVE DISKINESIA
TDS	THREE TIMES A DAY (TER IN DIE)
Tet.tox	TETANUS TOXOID

T/F	TRANSFER
TFT	THYROID FUNCTION TEST
THC	MARIJUANA
TIA	TRANSIENT ISCHAEMIC ATTACK
TOP	TERMINATION OF PREGNANCY
TPR	TEMPERATURE, PULSE AND RESPIRATION
T's & A's	TONSILLECTOMY AND ADENOIDECTOMY
TSDP	TREATMENT, SUPPORT AND DISCHARGE PLAN
TSH	THYROID STIMULATING HORMONE
TPP	TIME PERSON PLACE
TIS	TRANSLATION AND INTERPRETER SERVICE
Tx	TREATMENT

U

Abbreviation	Meaning
U & E	UREA AND ELECTROLYTES
U/A	URINALYSIS
UGA	UNESCORTED GROUND ACCESS
UMRN	UNIT MEDICAL RECORD NUMBER
URTI	UPPER RESPIRATORY TRACT INFECTION
UTI	URINARY TRACT INFECTION
UV	ULTRAVIOLET

V

Abbreviation	Meaning
V/B	VISITED BY
VEB	VENTRICULAR ECTOPIC BEATS

VF	VENTRICULAR FIBRILLATION
Vit	VITAMIN
VT	VENTRICULAR TACHYCARDIA
VRO	VIOLENCE RESTRAINING ORDER

W

Abbreviation	Meaning
W/R	WARD ROUND
WBC	WHITE BLOOD CELLS
WC	WHEELCHAIR
WCA	WORKERS COMPENSATION ACT
WEL	WEEKEND LEAVE
wks	WEEKS
w/e	WEEKEND
Wt.	WEIGHT

X

Abbreviation	Meaning
X MATCH	CROSS MATCH
X/R	X-RAY
x1A	1 PERSON ASSIST
x2A	2 PERSON ASSIST

Y

Abbreviation	Meaning
Yr	YEAR

yrs	YEARS
y/o	YEARS OLD

Signs & Symbols

Abbreviation	Meaning
~	APPROXIMATELY
*	BIRTH
†	DEATH
°	DEGREE: NORMAL
Δ	DIAGNOSIS; DISEASE
↓	DOWNGOING, LOWERED, DECREASED
=	EQUAL
#	FRACTURE
>	GREATER THAN
@	AT
<	LESS THAN
♂♀	MALE FEMALE
-ve	NEGATIVE
x/60	MINUTES
x/12	MONTHS
x/52	WEEKS
x/24	HOURS NOT TO BE USED WITH MEDICATION
x/7	DAYS NOT TO BE USED WITH MEDICATION
/	PER
%; %age	PER CENT; PERCENTAGE
+ve	POSITIVE

+/- ±	POSITIVE/NEGATIVE: PLUS, OR MINUS
1°	PRIMARY; 1st DEGREE
Δ	PROVISIONAL DIAGNOSIS; DISEASE
Ψ	PSYCHIATRIC
2°	SECONDARY; 2nd DEGREE
3°	TERTIARY; 3rd DEGREE
2WW	2 WHEEL WALKER
4WW	4 WHEEL WALKER
∴	THEREFORE
↑	UPGOING, RAISED, INCREASED
C	WITH
S	WITHOUT

5. Compliance

- Compliance will be reviewed during the annual documentation audit.
- 100% of medical records will have authorised abbreviations used.

Related internal policies, procedures, and guidelines

[NMHS MH Clinical Record Documentation Policy](#)

References

[Recommendations for terminology, abbreviations and symbols used in medicines documentation](#)

Policy Sponsor	Manager, Safety, Quality and Performance, NMHS MHPHDS				
Policy Contact	Quality Improvement Coordinator, NMHS MHPHDS				
Date First Issued:	01/01/2006	Last Reviewed:	04/03/2025	Review Date:	04/03/2028
Approved by:	Manager, Safety Quality and Performance NMHS MHPHDS			Date:	04/03/2025
Endorsed by:	Manager, Safety Quality and Performance NMHS MHPHDS			Date:	04/03/2025
NSQHS Standards Applicable:	☒  Std 1: Clinical Governance ☒  Std 2: Partnering with Consumers ☒  Std 3: Preventing and Controlling Healthcare Associated Infection ☒  Std 4: Medication Safety		☒  Std 5: Comprehensive Care ☒  Std 6: Communicating for Safety ☐  Std 7: Blood Management ☒  Std 8: Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration		
National Standards for Mental Health Services	☒ Std 1: Rights and Responsibilities ☐ Std 2: Safety ☐ Std 3: Consumer and Carer Participation ☐ Std 4: Diversity Responsibility ☐ Std 5: Promotion and Prevention ☐ Std 6: Consumers ☐ Std 7: Carers ☐ Std 8: Governance, leadership and management		☐ Std 9: Integration ☐ Std 10: Delivery of Care ☐ 10.1 Supporting Recovery ☐ 10.2 Access ☐ 10.3 Entry ☐ 10.4 Assessment and Review ☐ 10.5 Treatment and Support ☐ 10.6 Exit and Re-entry		
Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care:	Assessment, Care Planning, Physical Health Care of Mental Health Consumers,				
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Document Version Control			
Date	Version	Author	Notes
14/06/2019	V2.0	Quality Improvement Coordinator, NMHS MHPHDS	Scheduled Review: Updated template, references, and NSQHS Standards to V2.0, Addition of new abbreviations (services, diagnoses, sites) Removal of non-contemporary abbreviations.
11/08/2022	V3.0	MHPHDS QI Coordinator	Scheduled Review, information transferred to new MHPHDS template
04/03/2025	V4.0	MHPHDS QI Coordinator	Scheduled Review, inclusion of new position acronyms

The health impact upon Aboriginal people have been considered, and where relevant incorporated and appropriately addressed in the development of this health initiative (IS6P0419).

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